



MANAGING CONFLICT | EXERCISE 2

Conflict Resolution Analysis

Use the following template to break down the components of a conflict that you have experienced recently. Using points 1-4 document the conflict resolution style that you adopted and the outcome.

Ask yourself-was this the most appropriate way to resolve this conflict or would you adopt a different conflict style faced with this situation again?

If you **would** adopt a different approach, then below that, analyse using the conflict style you now consider to be most appropriate to try and resolve it to achieve the best outcome.

Important Considerations in Conflict Resolution:

- 1. Importance of the issue:** is having an optimal solution a nice to have, or is it fundamental to your recommendation / analysis?
- 2. The importance of the relationship:** is this somebody you will see one time or someone you will have to work with repeatedly?
- 3. Time constraints:** for example, when is the customer proposal due? Do you have the time to have a longer conversation to talk about your point of view?
- 4. Ultimate responsibility:** who ultimately has accountability and responsibility for the issue?

Conflict Resolution Analysis Template - Pre-filled Example

(A blank template can be found on the next page)

Describe the issue / conflict	<i>My manager disagrees with my proposed recommendation for a customer system specification.</i>		
Issue Importance (High/Medium/Low)	<i>High</i>	Time Constraints	<i>Deadline in 5 working days</i>
Relationship Importance (High/Medium/Low)	<i>High</i>	Ultimate responsibility	<i>My manager</i>
Conflict resolution style previously adopted & reasoning	<i>Avoiding – I decided not to address the disagreement directly with my manager due to the limited time available and the high stakes involved. I focused on completing the tasks within my manager's preferred approach to avoid potential conflict.</i>		
Previous outcome	<i>The issue was temporarily resolved, as the project moved forward based on my manager's decision. However, the lack of discussion meant that some important aspects of my recommendation were overlooked, which caused inefficiencies later in the implementation phase.</i>		
Conflict resolution style you would now adopt & detailed approach	<i>Collaborative - set aside 30-60 mins to talk through the evidence that supports my recommendation (provide data analysis, output modelling), adopt an open mind and listen to the manager's rationale, problem solve together to get a solution we both agree on and feel comfortable with, acknowledge my manager has ultimate responsibility for the outcome.</i>		
Likely outcome	<i>The most likely outcome is a well-researched and reasoned customer recommendation, using the experience of all parties.</i>		



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Issue Importance (High/Medium/Low)		Time Constraints	
Relationship Importance (High/Medium/Low)		Ultimate responsibility	
Conflict resolution style previously adopted & reasoning			
Previous outcome			
Conflict resolution style you would now adopt & detailed approach			
Likely outcome			